

Luke M. Perez

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Open for Remote or Relocation

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Summary Social scientist and U.S. Air Force veteran with 10+ years of experience transforming ambiguous assignments into fully scoped, evidence-based decisions and measurable results. Proven record troubleshooting mission-critical systems, handling classified information, and compliance reports. Skilled in both qualitative and quantitative analysis, stakeholder engagement, and talent development.

Skills

- **Research:** research design, stakeholder interviews and listening sessions, surveys and survey experiments, qualitative coding, quantitative + qualitative synthesis; hypothesis-driven troubleshooting; item-level performance analysis
- **Alignment & facilitation:** readiness reporting; regulated environments (IRB, FERPA, Privacy Act/FOIA, USAF Technical Orders, COMSEC/classified materials); workshop design and facilitation; conflict resolution; team self-governance design and process leadership; mentoring; influence-based leadership
- **Technical tools:** R (tidyverse, gt, R/exams), OLS/logit/probit; Markdown, Quarto, LaTeX, Make; Hugo; Canvas LMS; Claude Code

Experience

Assistant Professor The Ohio State University 2026–Present

- Direct Claude agents to audit, reorganize, and index a 4,500-file course archive and to build a tagged, privacy-screened database of professional records
- Researching project with Claude agents to scrape a website with an archive of government reporting across 25 years; developing a protocol for qualitative coding of records, indexing, and quantitative analysis of empirical metrics in records
- Completing book manuscript (80k words) on American security strategy during the Cold War using archival records and empirical analysis (OLS/probit)

Assistant Professor Arizona State University 2019–2025

- Informally led a committee tasked with analyzing low conversion rates to declared majors; used faculty listening sessions, student interviews, and comparative curriculum review of other majors to identify friction points; developed strategy for a lower-friction path and persuaded the department to implement revisions to major requirements

- Designed candidate evaluation rubric for screening 300+ applications and 15+ finalists across 6 faculty searches (2022–2025), including reproducible workflow for post-interview evaluation, leading to significant meeting-length reduction with increased rates of successful candidate hiring
- Advised 35+ students through 60+ tailored recommendations; advisees won a Rhodes Scholarship, two Pickering Fellowships, and several dozen admissions with funding to graduate schools (J.D., Ph.D., M.A.)

Postdoctoral Fellow University of Missouri

2018–2019

- Secured research grant for \$60,000 in support of book manuscript
- Directed competitive scholarship program: ran a university-wide application process and selected 40 students for a summer in Washington, D.C.
- Managed program operations and mentoring end to end: housing, guest-speaker schedule, and one-on-one coaching as each student-scholar secured their own internship (all found placements)

Staff Sergeant (E-5) U.S. Air National Guard

1998–2010

- Achieved 7-level “Craftsman” rating in avionics maintainance
- Troubleshoot flight-critical communication and navigation systems on multiple airframes (KC-135R, C-130, MQ-1/MQ-9) relying on USAF Technical Orders, under a variety of circumstances
- During the Pacer Craig glass-cockpit modification (1999–2002), designed hypothesis-testing protocols with senior USAF technicians and Raytheon engineers when documentation lagged the new systems
- Prepared monthly and quarterly mission-readiness reports for wing command combining personnel training, aircraft status, and inspection cycles
- Built individualized certification training plans for junior technicians; handled COMSEC materials under a Secret clearance

Education

PhD, Government, University of Texas at Austin, 2018

Professional Development

Blue Dot Impact, Future of AI, AGI Strategy (Intensive), October 2026